

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Hack Attacks

Ever been tongue-tied thinking up explanations for why your PC has been brought to its knees? Here's a favourite excuse/genuine reason: it's been hacked! But how? What kind of attack is it? Were there swords involved? Take your pick:

DDoS: A Distributed Denial of Service attack is carried out by flooding servers with data till they're crippled and can't service genuine requests. A popular method is the dreaded Ping of Death—pinging a server repeatedly from different sources. Most Web sites are still quite vulnerable to this type of attack, and it's a general favourite among those with malicious intent.

Trojan Horse: A program that comes disguised as something harmless, even useful, but really opens up access to a computer, making it a participant in a DDoS attack, or making it possible to use it to attack other computers.

Worm: True to their biological counterparts, worms keep consuming system resources, slowly overloading the system and finally causing it to cease functioning.

SQL Injection: Nothing like a flu shot, this is a technique whereby SQL commands are passed through a Web application so they get executed by a backend database. One of the most common application-layer attacks currently being used. To be able to perform SQL Injection hacking, all the attacker needs is a browser and some guesswork to figure table and field names.

Cross-Site Scripting: Called XSS or CSS, this is a security exploit in which the attacker inserts malicious code into any link that appears to be from a trustworthy source. When you click on the link, the embedded code is submitted as part of your Web request and can execute on your computer, possibly (and usually) allowing the attacker to steal information.

Things Get Hot

A couple of empty threats and (surprise, surprise) a rainy day later, Mumbai's oppressive summer is finally upon us. And because power must be conserved, our best friend the AC must rest on Fridays, according to some crazy law being aggressively enforced by the MSEB. High-horse alert: a lot of us being Bombayites, this hasn't gone down too well with us. But we've lowered our standards, and have elevated the once-ignored fan to a status higher than one's closest family members. Accusations were exchanged ("You stole my fan!" "Only because you stole mine first!"), friendships torn asunder, blood spilled, and heat-crazed employees of JDM ran the halls willy-nilly heralding the impending destruction of the Earth.

If it isn't the heat driving people crazy, it's the fact that our fifth anniversary is

DIGIT DIARY

coming up—Ed Deepak is already biting his nails at the prospect, and it is we unfortunate souls who must suffer ("Faster! We need to get ready for June!"). We seem to be headed for some really hard work for said issue, which only translates into sweetness and joy for our readers, so earmark some money from your piggy banks for... *The Big Bumper June Issue With Bells, Whistles, Clowns, Flaming Arrows, Three Monkeys, Twelve Pumpkins and a Chicken!* (Working Title)

Visual relief was provided this month by the models we auditioned for this month's cover ("There are Models in here? Female Models?"). To cut a long story short, the photography studio will be investing in stronger locks soon.

Yes, we're quite shameless here, and we're not in the least ashamed to admit it.

Hunt then tried to negotiate a lower figure with a representative, who told her it was not negotiable. The rep suggested she drop out of MIT and attend a much lower-priced community college, and get a real job to pay her fine. "I was flabbergasted," Hunt said. "I started laughing at her and said, 'You cannot be serious!'"

Hunt is trying to raise the money via several means, including a Web site, ScrewPirates.com. Shouldn't that have been "ScrewTheRIAA.com" or something of that sort? We're sure that would attract more potential benefactors!

Makes you feel you're lucky to be living here in India, where software is effectively free for most people, where there's no RIAA, and where the police don't have a clue about what "illegal file sharing" is!

LITERALLY

Make Love, Not War

We've heard about flirting and dating in online games such as *EverQuest* and *World*

of *Warcraft*, sometimes even leading to marriage between players, despite no romantic or sexual features in these games. And we've also seen single-player sex games such as *VirtuallyJenna*, where you basically do sex-oriented stuff all by yourself. Now, a new crop of adults-only games will combine the player-to-player interaction of online games and the graphic sexuality of single-player sex games!

In *Naughty America: The Game*, set to launch soon, players will take on the forms of sexually appealing—albeit cartoon-like—people who meet, flirt and have sex with other players. And in *Red Light Center*, a game available in test version, players are 3D characters in a red-light district. They can talk to each other through headsets.

Sex sells, but will these games? That, according to those in the industry, is not a given. Sure, these games combine all the elements that go into online success—interactivity, immersion, realism, and, of course, sex. But how many people want to have sex online?

It's not clear. For one,



online sex seems to us to offer no extra titillation over what people get from single-player sex games. Now, what's been called cybersex—sexually-oriented online chatting—is, of course, hugely popular. But the reason is that it tickles the imagination. How will simulated sex in a game help? Of course, one can argue that chat—including voice chat—is included in the games, and that the actions people do augment that chat. But we think that augmenting the chat is the only thing the rest of the game will accomplish.

One thing is clear, though: if cybersex can be considered cheating—and